

Listen to the radio

The invention of radio was so revolutionary that developments since have made only minor improvements. Digital radio has massively increased the range of what we can listen to, but the experience of listening to the radio today remains little altered from a century ago.

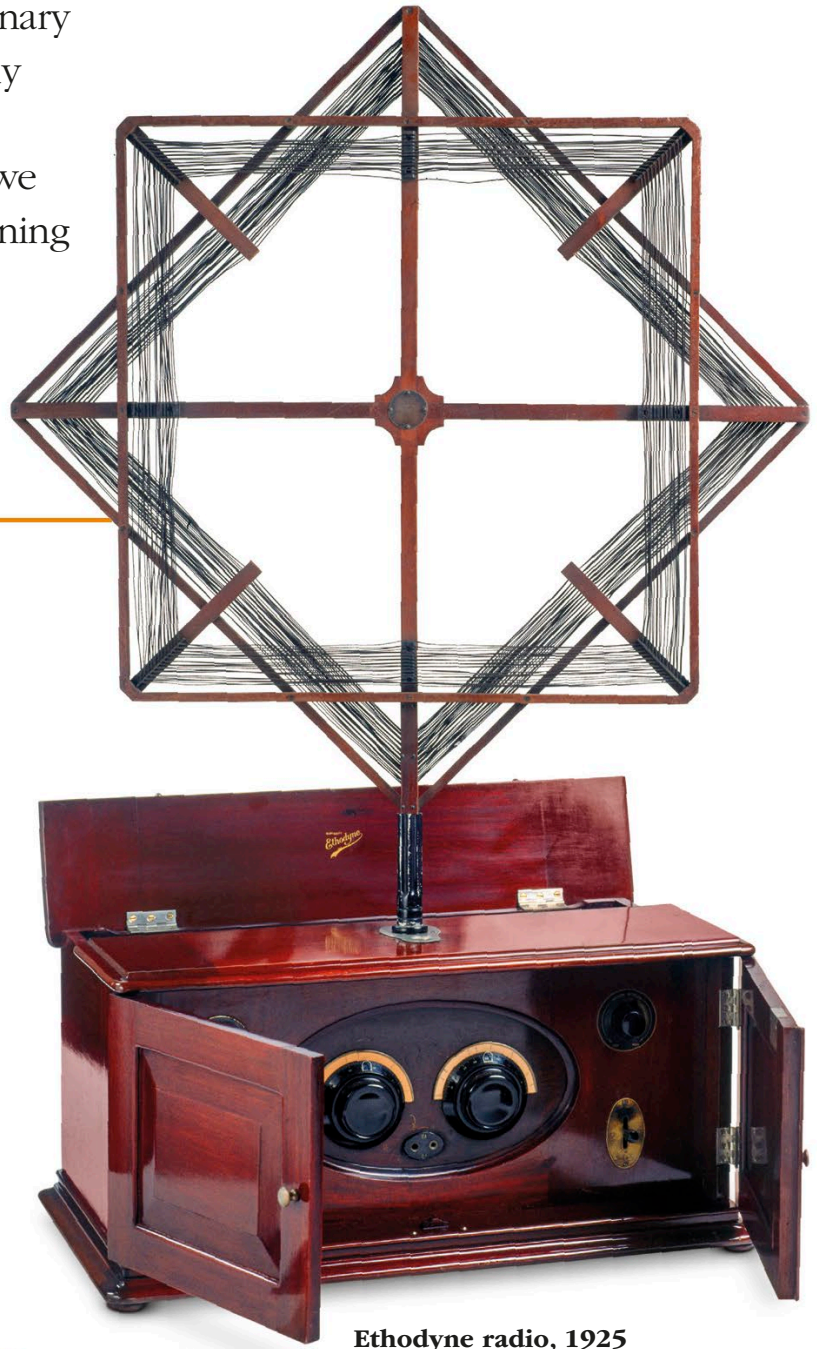
Ethodyne radio

- **What?** Superheterodyne circuit
- **Who?** Edward Howard Armstrong
- **Where and when?** US, 1919

New York-born Edward Howard Armstrong was fascinated by radios from childhood. As an adult, he invented FM radio, now the most popular system, and also a way in which radio receivers could in effect shift every station to the same frequency. This greatly simplified their design and made them more sensitive and easier to tune.

FAST FACTS

- In 1908, in Paris, France, on his honeymoon, Lee de Forest broadcasted music from the top of the Eiffel Tower, becoming the first radio DJ in history.
- In 1920, the world's first commercial radio station, KDKA, went on the air in Pittsburgh, PA.



Ethodyne radio, 1925

Backpack military radio

- **What?** SCR-300
- **Who?** Motorola
- **Where and when?** US, 1940

In 1940, Motorola was asked by the US War Department to develop a portable, battery-powered radio for use by the military during World War II. It was the first radio to be nicknamed a “walkie-talkie.”

